

LOCATION

The Camargue lies within the Rhône Delta, on the Mediterranean coast of southeastern France.

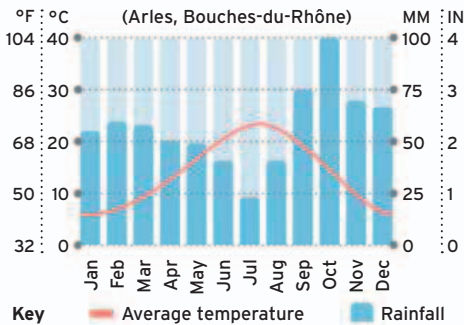


Lunel Saint-Gilles Arles 0 km 10 0 miles 10

Mediterranean Sea

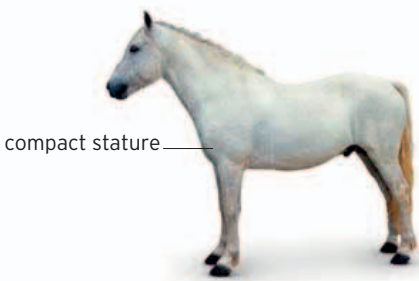
CLIMATE

The area is extremely hot in summer with up to 100% humidity, and is often subject to persistent chilling mistral winds in winter and spring.



Camargue horse

Equus caballus



Although their exact origin is unknown, horses have lived in the salty marshlands of southern France, particularly around the Rhône Delta, for thousands of years. Today, Camargue horses live a semiwild existence as a protected breed. If described in horsebreeding terms, these small, compact horses are technically “gray” not white. When born, the foals are black or brown—the horses only turn gray at around four years old.

Water horses

Rugged and sturdy, Camargue horses are never stabled, nor are their hard hoofs ever shod. They survive extreme weather conditions partly by grazing on plants too tough for other herbivores. However, their even temperament and agility lead many to be tamed and ridden, and they are used to help manage the feral black Camargue cattle that also live in the wetlands.

- ↔ 7 ft (2.1m)
- ⚖ 660–880 lb (300–400 kg)
- ⊗ Endangered
- 🌿 Grass, leaves, herbs
- 🏠 🌳 🌳 🌳



S. Europe (Camargue)

Camargues are known in France as “horses of the sea”

▽ RUNNING FREE

Camargue horses naturally live in small herds, with the mares and foals usually led by a single dominant stallion.



More than 400 species of bird

THREATENED FISH

Eels were once the most common predatory fish in the Camargue, but they have declined here as elsewhere. This is due to a combination of pollution, the damming of their migration routes, and a parasitic nematode.

EUROPEAN EEL